

THE SETUP VAULT

The Desk Setup Starter Checklist

*Most desk upgrades don't fail because of the product.
They fail because nobody checked if it was the right fix first.*

What's Actually Bothering You?

Before you look at a single product, get specific about what's actually wrong. Check everything that applies — you're not committing to anything yet, just naming the problem.

☐

Cables are visible, tangled, or in the way

☐

My monitor or laptop is at a bad height or angle

☐

My desk feels cluttered or disorganized

☐

Lighting makes the space feel bad to work in

☐

I don't have enough desk space

☐

I don't know what's actually wrong — it just doesn't feel right

Whatever you checked, hold onto it. The next page uses this to help you decide whether you actually need to buy something — or just need a plan.

The "Don't Buy It Yet" Check

Five questions. Answer honestly before you add anything to a cart.

1. Can I fix this with what I already own, rearranged?

YES

NO

2. Have I measured the space this needs to fit?

YES

NO

3. Is this solving the actual problem, or just the first thing I noticed?

YES

NO

4. Would I still want this in a month?

YES

NO

5. Do I know exactly where this goes before I click "buy"?

YES

NO

Two or more "no"s? Pause. You're not ready to buy yet — you're ready to plan.

3 Fastest Wins — No Purchase Required

1. Do a 2-minute equipment pass

List everything currently on or under your desk that you haven't touched in the past week. Move it off the desk surface. Don't decide what to do with it yet — just clear it.

2. Reset your zones

Using only what you already own, mark out three rough areas: what you touch constantly, what you touch occasionally, and where cables/chargers live. See if your current layout actually matches how you work.

3. Sort one pile

Pick one drawer or one pile and sort it into daily / occasional / rarely / doesn't belong here. Remove the "doesn't belong" pile from the desk entirely.

Where To Go From Here

This checklist helps you identify what's wrong and take three real first steps. When you're ready to actually plan the fix, here's where to go next.

Want to actually plan the fix?

The Starter Checklist helps you identify what's wrong. The paid tools help you work through what to do next.

Cable clutter is the main problem?

**Ultimate Desk Setup &
Cable Management Guide**
\$10

Your workspace needs a broader plan?

**The Complete
Desk Setup Planner**
\$19